

Woolworths Group Board of Directors: Profiles and Strategic Focus Areas

Updated: March 2026

1. Executive Summary

The Board of Directors of Woolworths Group is composed of individuals with a diverse and extensive range of experiences, strategically aligned to navigate the complexities of the modern retail landscape. The collective expertise of the board spans critical domains including traditional retail operations, food retail and fresh food innovation, advanced digital transformation and e-commerce, technology and AI-driven product development, robust financial management, corporate governance, and an increasing emphasis on sustainability. This composition, featuring both long-tenured directors possessing deep institutional knowledge and more recent appointees bringing fresh international perspectives, suggests a governance structure equipped for both stability and adaptive change.

The recent Board renewal — with Ken Meyer (October 2025) and Jon Alferness (March 2026) replacing Holly Kramer and Tracey Fellows — represents a deliberate strategic pivot. The Board has materially strengthened its capabilities in two areas identified as critical to long-term competitive positioning: deep operational food retail expertise (particularly in fresh food, store operations, and supply chain) and retail-specific technology leadership (particularly in digital product development, generative AI deployment, and omnichannel integration at scale). Both new directors bring direct US grocery and retail technology experience, including firsthand knowledge of Amazon's approach to food retail and Walmart's digital transformation — two of the most significant competitive forces shaping the global and Australian grocery markets.

The backgrounds and committee assignments of the board members indicate a clear focus on several strategic priorities. These include steering the Group through an intensely competitive retail environment, aggressively pursuing growth in digital and e-commerce channels, driving fresh food excellence and innovation, embedding sustainability as a core business principle, and a pronounced effort to rebuild and maintain customer trust amidst evolving consumer expectations and market scrutiny. The deliberate inclusion of multiple directors with significant backgrounds in digital technologies, e-commerce, and now AI-driven retail transformation underscores a proactive approach to embedding digital capabilities at the highest level of strategic oversight, reflecting a fundamental shift in the retail sector.

Furthermore, a consistent theme emerging from the profiles and public statements of several directors, including the Chair and the CEO, is a heightened awareness of customer sentiment and the strategic imperative of fostering strong, trust-based relationships. This points to a board-level commitment to addressing brand perception and ensuring the Group's long-term social licence to operate, which are integral to sustained shareholder value.

A gap to monitor following the Board renewal is the Sustainability Committee Chair role, previously held by Holly Kramer, whose leadership in ESG governance across Woolworths and ANZ was a significant asset. The Board will need to ensure continued momentum in sustainability strategy and governance.

2. Woolworths Group Board of Directors: Composition and

Mandate

2.1. Overview of the Board's Stated Objectives and Responsibilities

The Woolworths Group Board of Directors operates with the principal objective of maintaining and increasing shareholder value, while concurrently ensuring that the overall activities of the Group are managed with propriety and effectiveness. In its capacity, the Board is tasked with representing and serving the interests of shareholders. This is achieved through diligent oversight and appraisal of the Group's overarching strategy, its policies, and its operational and financial performance.

Each Director conducts their duties in accordance with the Woolworths Group Board Charter. This foundational document outlines their specific powers, delineates their responsibilities, and provides a framework for how they can best represent shareholder interests, while also having regard for international best practices in corporate governance and all applicable laws. The Board Charter is thus central to the governance framework, establishing the formal parameters within which individual directors and the Board collectively operate and make decisions impacting the Group.

2.2. Current Board Members and Key Committee Structures

The current Board of Directors of Woolworths Group comprises nine individuals, including the Chair and the CEO & Managing Director. The members are: Scott Perkins, Amanda Bardwell, Maxine Brenner, Jennifer Carr-Smith, Philip Chronican, Kathee Tesija, Warwick Bray, Ken Meyer, and Jon Alferness.

To support its functions and ensure focused attention on critical areas, the Board has established several permanent committees. These include the Audit & Finance Committee, the Nomination Committee, the People Committee, the Risk Committee, and the Sustainability Committee. The existence of these specialised committees allows for more detailed scrutiny and deeper engagement on complex issues, thereby enhancing the quality of governance and oversight.

Table 1: Woolworths Group Board of Directors – Overview (March 2026)

Name	Role	Appointment Date	Key Woolworths Committee Memberships
Scott Perkins	Independent Chair	1 September 2014 (Chair since October 2022)	As Board Chair, ex-officio member of all committees; Chair of Nomination Committee
Amanda Bardwell	CEO & Managing Director	1 September 2024	As CEO, accountable to the Board and works with all committees; member of Group Executive Committee
Maxine Brenner	Non-Executive Director	1 December 2020	Re-elected at 2024 AGM; member of Audit & Finance Committee, Risk Committee, Nomination Committee

Jennifer Carr-Smith	Non-Executive Director	17 May 2019	Member: Audit & Finance Committee, Nomination Committee, People Committee, Sustainability Committee
Philip Chronican	Non-Executive Director	1 October 2021	Re-elected at 2024 AGM; member: Audit & Finance Committee, Risk Committee, Nomination Committee
Kathee Tesija	Non-Executive Director	9 May 2016	Member: Sustainability Committee
Warwick Bray	Non-Executive Director	1 March 2023	Chair: Audit & Finance Committee
Ken Meyer	Non-Executive Director	1 October 2025	Committee assignments to be confirmed; likely aligned with operations and sustainability
Jon Alferness	Non-Executive Director	1 March 2026	Committee assignments to be confirmed; will stand for election at 2026 AGM

2.3. Recent Board Changes

Departed (2025–2026):

Holly Kramer retired at the conclusion of the 2025 AGM after more than nine years of service (appointed February 2016). She served as Chair of the Sustainability Committee and was a significant contributor to the Group's sustainability agenda and remuneration approach. She also brought direct retail CEO experience (Best & Less), extensive people and culture expertise (Chair of Ethics, Environment, Social and Governance Committee and People & Culture Committee at ANZ), and sustainability advisory experience (Senior Advisor to Pollination, a climate investment firm). Her departure creates a leadership gap in sustainability governance that the Board will need to address.

Tracey Fellows retired from the Board ahead of Jon Alferness's appointment (appointed March 2023). She was a member of the People Committee and brought extensive global technology and digital media executive experience from roles at News Corp (President, Global Digital Real Estate), REA Group (CEO), Australia Post (Executive General Manager), and Microsoft (President, Asia Pacific; CEO, Australia). She contributed perspectives on digital transformation, technology strategy, digital identity, and the ethical implications of emerging technologies.

Joined (2025–2026):

Ken Meyer (appointed 1 October 2025) brings 24 years at Whole Foods Market, most recently as EVP of Operations for North America and the UK. He provides deep expertise in food retail operations, fresh food innovation and meal solutions, store design and development, and retail supply chain. His experience of the Amazon acquisition of Whole Foods offers direct insight into how Amazon approaches grocery retail. He is currently active in food and beverage private equity (Executive Partner at Shore Capital; Founding Partner at Midnight Ventures Partners).

Jon Alferness (appointed 1 March 2026) is a highly experienced technology and product leader with 20+ years in Silicon Valley and the global retail sector. He was most recently EVP and Chief Product Officer for Walmart US, leading digital transformation across eCommerce, financial services, last-mile delivery, and associate tools — including pioneering generative AI deployment in retail operations. His prior career includes 13 years at Google (VP of Product Management for shopping, travel, and ads), senior roles at Lyft and Pinterest, and CPO of Varo Bank. He brings retail-specific technology expertise that is directly relevant to Woolworths' digital strategy.

3. In-Depth Profiles of Woolworths Group Board Members

3.1. Scott Perkins

3.1.1. Official Role and Tenure at Woolworths Group: Scott Perkins serves as the Independent Chair of the Woolworths Group Board, a position he was appointed to on 26 October 2022. He has been a Director of the company since 1 September 2014. This long tenure, culminating in his appointment as Chair, signifies substantial institutional knowledge of Woolworths Group and indicates a position of considerable influence on the Board.

3.1.2. Comprehensive Professional Background and Experience: Mr. Perkins has an extensive career as a public company director and a leading corporate advisor with significant Australian and international experience in strategy, mergers and acquisitions (M&A), and capital market matters. From 1999 to 2013, he held senior executive leadership positions at Deutsche Bank. These roles included Managing Director and Head of Corporate Finance for Australia and New Zealand, membership of the Asia Pacific Corporate and Investment Bank Management Committee, and Chief Executive Officer of Deutsche Bank New Zealand. This background points to strong financial acumen and strategic leadership capabilities at an international level. He was also a Director of Brambles Limited, another major ASX-listed company, from June 2015 to October 2024.

3.1.3. Core Expertise, Skills, and Educational Qualifications: His core expertise lies in corporate strategy, M&A, capital markets, corporate finance, and corporate governance. Mr. Perkins holds a Bachelor of Commerce (BCom) and a Bachelor of Laws (LLB (Hons)) from Auckland University.

3.1.4. Committee Memberships and Responsibilities: As Chair of the Woolworths Group Board, Mr. Perkins is typically an ex-officio member of all board committees and chairs the Nomination Committee. At Origin Energy, where he also serves as Chair, he is Chair of the Nomination Committee and a member of the Audit and Risk, Remuneration, People and Culture, and Safety and Sustainability committees.

3.1.5. Other Current and Past Directorships and Key Affiliations: Mr. Perkins is currently the Chair of Origin Energy, appointed in October 2020 after serving as a Director since September 2015. He is also Chair of the Garvan Institute of Medical Research (since December 2023), founding Chairman of Sweet Louise, a New Zealand charity supporting women with metastatic breast cancer, and a Non-executive Director of the New Zealand Initiative, a public policy think tank. His past directorships include Non-Executive Chairman at Sirius Minerals plc, Executive Director at FMG, and Non-Executive Director roles at Commonwealth Properties Ltd, EDS Australia, Mobilesoft, Telecom New Zealand Australia P/L, and Athletics Australia.

3.1.6. Inferred Preferences and Public Stance: Mr. Perkins demonstrates a strong advocacy for robust corporate governance and strategic clarity, a natural extension of his Chair roles and corporate advisory background. While deeply committed to shareholder value, his public statements increasingly reflect a balanced consideration of broader stakeholder interests, particularly customer trust and sustainability. He recently acknowledged that "customer trust in our brand has been impacted and we have work to do to restore this trust," and his chairmanship at Origin has overseen significant sustainability reporting. His philanthropic commitments to breast cancer causes, the visual arts, and public policy development further

indicate a broad societal perspective. Recent statements show a focus on addressing cost-of-living pressures for customers and defending Woolworths' pricing strategies amid public and regulatory scrutiny. He also firmly stated that the CEO succession timeline was "completely unaffected by external events," suggesting a preference for maintaining orderly and independent governance processes.

3.1.7. Likely Key Areas of Focus and Influence within Woolworths Board Meetings: As Chair, Mr. Perkins is likely to focus on overall group strategy, long-term financial performance, and prudent capital allocation. Ensuring the effectiveness of corporate governance frameworks and providing board leadership will be paramount. A significant area of his attention will be managing stakeholder relations, particularly maintaining investor confidence and shaping public perception, especially concerning sensitive issues like pricing, competition, and social responsibility. He will also be keenly focused on overseeing the performance of the CEO, Amanda Bardwell, and ensuring smooth integration of the two new international directors. His dual chairmanship of Woolworths and Origin Energy provides unique cross-pollination of insights on complex issues such as decarbonisation strategies, building supply chain resilience, and managing heightened public and regulatory scrutiny. His long tenure embodies the Board's institutional memory – a crucial stabilising factor during periods of change, while necessitating conscious openness to the fresh perspectives brought by newer board members.

3.2. Amanda Bardwell

3.2.1. Official Role and Tenure at Woolworths Group: Amanda Bardwell has been appointed Chief Executive Officer and Managing Director of Woolworths Group, with her role becoming effective on 1 September 2024. This appointment is pivotal, marking her as the 13th CEO in the Group's history and its first female chief executive, coinciding with Woolworths approaching its 100th anniversary.

3.2.2. Comprehensive Professional Background and Experience: Ms. Bardwell is a long-serving executive of Woolworths Group, having joined the company in 2001. Her deep institutional knowledge is complemented by a track record of significant achievement within the Group. Most notably, she served as the Managing Director of WooliesX, the Group's e-commerce, digital, customer loyalty, and rewards division, since March 2017. Under her leadership, WooliesX was transformed from a nascent operation into a \$7 billion market-leading business, a key factor in her elevation to CEO. Throughout her 23-year career at Woolworths, she has held a variety of roles across both the Supermarket and Drinks businesses, including head of marketing. Since taking the helm as CEO, she has affirmed the Group's commitment to value, expanding the "Lower Shelf Price" initiative to more than 800 products.

3.2.3. Core Expertise, Skills, and Educational Qualifications: Her core expertise encompasses e-commerce, digital strategy and transformation, retail innovation, development and management of customer loyalty programs, marketing, and general management. Ms. Bardwell holds an MBA from the University of New South Wales and a Bachelor of Business from the University of Technology Queensland. She is also an active member of Chief Executive Women.

3.2.4. Committee Memberships and Responsibilities: As the CEO and Managing Director, Ms. Bardwell is directly accountable to the Board of Directors and works closely with all its committees. She is a key member of the Group Executive Committee, responsible for management decisions and operations.

3.2.5. Inferred Preferences and Public Stance: Ms. Bardwell is a strong advocate for digital innovation and customer-centric solutions, demonstrated by her transformative success with WooliesX. She champions leveraging data and analytics to enhance customer experiences and drive business performance. She has acknowledged the challenges facing Woolworths, including pressures on customer trust and earnings, and has emphasised the importance of restoring customer confidence, particularly in the context of cost-of-living pressures and growing e-commerce (with its currently lower margins). Her leadership style reflects a "modern retailer" approach, integrating digital capabilities seamlessly with traditional retail

strengths.

3.2.6. Likely Key Areas of Focus and Influence within Woolworths Board Meetings: As CEO, Ms. Bardwell will drive the Group's overall strategic direction with significant emphasis on accelerating digital growth, expanding e-commerce capabilities, and refining the omnichannel retail strategy. A critical challenge will be improving profitability across all channels, particularly addressing e-commerce margin differentials. Strengthening customer loyalty programs and personalised marketing will also be key. She will need to navigate ongoing competitive pressures and the impact of cost-of-living challenges on consumer behaviour, while enhancing operational efficiency. She is also expected to continue fostering the "Customer 1st, Team 1st" culture. The selection of Ms. Bardwell signals the Board's conviction that future competitive advantage is significantly tied to leveraging digital capabilities, data analytics, and sophisticated customer engagement — making digital thinking core to Group strategy. Her 23-year tenure positions her uniquely to drive transformation from within, with deep understanding of culture, operations, and systems.

3.3. Maxine Brenner

3.3.1. Official Role and Tenure at Woolworths Group: Maxine Brenner serves as a Non-Executive Director on the Woolworths Group Board, having been appointed on 1 December 2020. She was re-elected at the 2024 Annual General Meeting.

3.3.2. Comprehensive Professional Background and Experience: Ms. Brenner is a highly experienced director, with over 20 years of service on the boards of ASX top-20 companies. Her executive career included the role of Managing Director of Investment Banking at Investec Bank (Australia) Ltd, providing a strong foundation in finance and corporate advisory. Prior to her banking career, she practised as a corporate lawyer with Freehill Hollingdale & Page (now Herbert Smith Freehills) and also lectured in the Faculty of Law at both the University of New South Wales and the University of Sydney. She was appointed as an Operating Partner for the global private equity firm Advent International in late 2025. Her previous directorships include Orica Limited (April 2013 to December 2022), Growthpoint Properties Australia Limited (March 2012 to November 2020), Qantas Airways Limited (August 2013 to February 2024), and Origin Energy (November 2013 to October 2025). She is a former member of the Takeovers Panel.

3.3.3. Core Expertise, Skills, and Educational Qualifications: Her core expertise lies in corporate advisory, finance, regulatory sectors, corporate law, and investment banking. She is also noted for bringing a strong customer perspective to her board roles. Ms. Brenner holds a Bachelor of Arts (BA) and a Bachelor of Laws (LLB) from the University of New South Wales.

3.3.4. Committee Memberships and Responsibilities: At Woolworths, Ms. Brenner serves on the Audit & Finance Committee, Risk Committee, and Nomination Committee. At Telstra, she is the Chair of the Risk and Sustainability Committee and a member of the People and Remuneration Committee and the Nomination Committee. At Brambles, where she serves as Chair (since December 2024), she is Chair of the Nominations Committee and a member of the Remuneration Committee.

3.3.5. Other Current and Past Directorships and Key Affiliations: Ms. Brenner is currently Chair of Brambles Limited (since December 2024), Director of Telstra Group Limited (since February 2023), Operating Partner at Advent International, and a member of the University of NSW Council. Her past directorships include Qantas Airways Limited (2013–2024), Orica Limited (2013–2022), Origin Energy (2013–2025), Growthpoint Properties Australia, Treasury Corporation of NSW, Bulmer Australia, Neverfail Spring Water, and she was Deputy Chair of the Federal Airports Corporation.

3.3.6. Inferred Preferences and Public Stance: Ms. Brenner places a strong focus on understanding and responding to the changing nature of customer expectations. Her committee chairmanships at Telstra underscore a commitment to robust risk management and advancing sustainability agendas. Her departure from the Qantas board in February 2024 was part of a broader board renewal initiative occurring

during a period when the airline acknowledged a "substantial loss of trust," indicating her experience in navigating complex reputational challenges.

3.3.7. Likely Key Areas of Focus and Influence within Woolworths Board Meetings: Ms. Brenner contributes significantly to discussions on risk management frameworks, sustainability strategy, corporate governance, and regulatory compliance. Her legal background and Takeovers Panel experience inform her perspective on regulatory matters. She is well-positioned to advise on financial strategy and capital management. Her concurrent directorships at Woolworths, Telstra, and Brambles place her at a unique intersection of retail, telecommunications, and logistics, providing multifaceted understanding of systemic risks (supply chains, cybersecurity, climate change) and cross-sector opportunities. Her experience at Qantas during its period of reputational difficulty makes her particularly valuable as Woolworths navigates its own heightened public and regulatory attention.

3.4. Jennifer Carr-Smith

3.4.1. Official Role and Tenure at Woolworths Group: Jennifer Carr-Smith is a Non-Executive Director of Woolworths Group, appointed on 17 May 2019.

3.4.2. Comprehensive Professional Background and Experience: Ms. Carr-Smith is a seasoned board director and accomplished online retail executive with over 25 years of experience, focused on guiding organisations through periods of rapid growth and digital transformation across sectors including consumer packaged goods (CPG), apparel, food/grocery, and internet-based businesses. A highlight of her executive career was her role as President and CEO of Peapod, a significant online grocery delivery service in the United States. She also served as Senior Vice President and General Manager of North America Local at Groupon. Her extensive e-commerce operational leadership is further evidenced by Chief Operating Officer roles at J. Crew Direct, giggle, and Gilt.com. She is the Founder and President of JCS Advisory Services, LLC, consulting for start-up and high-growth companies in the digital, retail, and consumer spaces. She also co-founded and was President of Athena Consumer Acquisition Corp., a SPAC. Previous directorships include Full Harvest (January 2020 to December 2022), Chair of Blue Apron (2020 to 2023), and Director of Local Bounti Corporation (April 2023 to March 2025).

3.4.3. Core Expertise, Skills, and Educational Qualifications: Her core expertise lies in online retail, e-commerce strategy and operations (particularly in the grocery sector), digital transformation, scaling businesses, CPG, apparel, supply chain management, customer experience enhancement, and data analytics. Ms. Carr-Smith holds a BA in Economics from Brown University and an MBA from Harvard Business School.

3.4.4. Committee Memberships and Responsibilities: At Woolworths, Ms. Carr-Smith is a member of the Audit & Finance Committee, the Nomination Committee, the People Committee, and the Sustainability Committee. She also serves as a Board Director for Perdue Farms.

3.4.5. Inferred Preferences and Public Stance: Her career demonstrates a strong belief in leveraging digital technologies to drive growth and transformation in retail and grocery sectors. She emphasises operational excellence in e-commerce, including sophisticated supply chain management and efficient last-mile delivery. While a proponent of online grocery's potential, she also pragmatically acknowledges its inherent challenges, such as thin margins and significant capital requirements. Her directorships at Full Harvest and Local Bounti suggest an interest in sustainable and innovative food systems.

3.4.6. Likely Key Areas of Focus and Influence within Woolworths Board Meetings: Ms. Carr-Smith brings invaluable hands-on operational experience from leading Peapod in the U.S. online grocery market — directly tackling challenges around scaling, thin margins, and last-mile logistics that are precisely relevant to Woolworths' e-commerce operations. Her broad committee membership allows multifaceted contributions. Her directorships in innovative food companies give her a forward-looking perspective on sustainable food

systems, potentially influencing Woolworths towards more transformative sustainability initiatives in sourcing and operations. She is a natural collaborator with new director Jon Alferness on digital strategy discussions, while her grocery-specific e-commerce experience provides a complementary operational lens to his technology and product leadership background.

3.5. Philip Chronican

3.5.1. Official Role and Tenure at Woolworths Group: Philip Chronican is a Non-Executive Director of Woolworths Group, having been appointed on 1 October 2021. He was re-elected at the 2024 AGM.

3.5.2. Comprehensive Professional Background and Experience: Mr. Chronican possesses extensive strategic, financial, and management expertise, cultivated over a career spanning more than 40 years in the banking and financial services sectors in Australia and New Zealand. He currently serves as the Chairman of National Australia Bank (NAB), a role he assumed in November 2019 after joining the NAB Board in May 2016. He also served as NAB's Interim Group CEO from March to November 2019, guiding the bank during a critical period following the Royal Commission into Misconduct in the Banking, Superannuation and Financial Services Industry. Prior to NAB, he was responsible for the Retail and Commercial banking business of ANZ in Australia. His long career at Westpac Banking Corporation included key positions such as Group Chief Financial Officer (CFO) and Group Executive of its Institutional banking business. He has broad experience in M&A activity and post-merger integration. He was previously the Chair of the Westmead Institute for Medical Research (to December 2024).

3.5.3. Core Expertise, Skills, and Educational Qualifications: His core areas of expertise include banking and financial services leadership, corporate strategy, risk management, capital management, M&A execution, post-merger integration, corporate governance, ethical conduct, and promoting workforce diversity. He also has a noted interest in the impact of climate change on customers and the broader economy. Mr. Chronican holds a Bachelor of Commerce with Honours (BCom (Hons)) in Economics from the University of Otago, an MBA with Distinction from IMD, is a Graduate of the Australian Institute of Company Directors (GAICD), and a Senior Fellow of FINSIA (SF Fin).

3.5.4. Committee Memberships and Responsibilities: At Woolworths, Mr. Chronican is a member of the Audit & Finance Committee, the Risk Committee, and the Nomination Committee. As Chairman of NAB, he also chairs NAB's Nomination & Governance Committee.

3.5.5. Inferred Preferences and Public Stance: Mr. Chronican is a vocal advocate for greater transparency and higher ethical standards, and a proponent of promoting workforce diversity. He has taken a strong and public interest in climate change and its impacts. He has emphasised the critical importance of aligning an organisation's internal behaviour and culture with its external brand promises, cautioning to "never make a promise that you don't know that you're going to be able to keep." He stresses the need for a clear long-term vision and effective communication of strategy. As NAB Chair, his focus has been on consistent and disciplined execution of strategy, fostering a strong culture, upholding robust governance, and ensuring accountability.

3.5.6. Likely Key Areas of Focus and Influence within Woolworths Board Meetings: Mr. Chronican's leadership of NAB during the post-Banking Royal Commission period — rebuilding trust, reforming ethics, strengthening governance — provides Woolworths with a director deeply experienced in navigating intense public and regulatory scrutiny and driving significant cultural change centred on accountability. With Woolworths facing its own scrutiny on pricing, market power, and supplier relationships, his experience in addressing "trust deficits" is exceptionally valuable. His philosophy of aligning actions with promises and "consistently doing the basics well for customers" will drive rigorous accountability. He provides critical financial oversight, risk management, and governance perspectives through his committee memberships.

3.6. Kathee Tesija

3.6.1. Official Role and Tenure at Woolworths Group: Kathee Tesija is a Non-Executive Director on the Woolworths Group Board, appointed on 9 May 2016.

3.6.2. Comprehensive Professional Background and Experience: Ms. Tesija brings extensive United States retailing experience, with a particular specialisation in merchandising and supply chain management. Her distinguished 30-year executive career was with Target Corporation in the US, where she rose to the position of Chief Merchandising and Supply Chain Officer and Executive Vice President. In this capacity, she played a pivotal role in Target's significant growth into a \$73 billion company and its expansion from 226 to 1,800 stores. After stepping down from her executive role, she continued to serve Target as a Strategic Advisor until 2016. Her career at Target began in 1986, progressing through roles including merchandise analyst, buyer, divisional merchandise manager, and Senior Vice President of Hardlines. She was previously a Director of Verizon Communications, Inc. (2012 to May 2020) and The Clorox Company (May 2020 to November 2024).

3.6.3. Core Expertise, Skills, and Educational Qualifications: Her core expertise encompasses retail merchandising, global supply chain management, product design and development, international sourcing, inventory management, understanding consumer behaviour, and translating market insights into actionable and profitable business strategies. Ms. Tesija holds a Bachelor of Science in Retail Merchandising and Management (BSRMM) with a focus on Fashion Merchandising from the University of Wisconsin – Stout.

3.6.4. Committee Memberships and Responsibilities: At Woolworths, Ms. Tesija is a member of the Sustainability Committee. She currently acts as a senior advisor and consultant for Simpatful, a retail consulting agency in the US.

3.6.5. Inferred Preferences and Public Stance: Ms. Tesija possesses a profound understanding of consumer behaviour and a proven ability to translate these insights into effective retail strategies. Her career at Target underscores an emphasis on robust merchandising capabilities and highly efficient supply chains as core competencies for retail success. She has direct experience in navigating the fundamental shift from in-store to omnichannel retail. She has publicly endorsed principles of effective communication and empathetic leadership.

3.6.6. Likely Key Areas of Focus and Influence within Woolworths Board Meetings: Ms. Tesija is a significant contributor to discussions on merchandising strategy, private label development, and global product sourcing. Her expertise in supply chain optimisation and inventory management is directly relevant. She provides a unique perspective on consumer trends informed by the competitive US retail environment. Her experience with Target's omnichannel evolution informs discussions on integrating online and physical store experiences. Her current consulting role at Simpatful keeps her knowledge contemporary. She is a natural collaborator with Ken Meyer on retail operations and supply chain discussions, with their complementary backgrounds (Target's general merchandise/mass-market expertise alongside Whole Foods' fresh food/premium grocery focus) enriching the Board's retail operational depth.

3.7. Warwick Bray

3.7.1. Official Role and Tenure at Woolworths Group: Warwick Bray is a Non-Executive Director of Woolworths Group, appointed to the Board on 1 March 2023.

3.7.2. Comprehensive Professional Background and Experience: Mr. Bray brings extensive expertise in finance and strategy, accumulated over decades of experience in the international telecommunications, technology, and media sectors. He is the former Chief Financial Officer of Telstra, Australia's leading telecommunications company. During his tenure at Telstra, he also held various other senior leadership roles, including Group Managing Director of Mobile and Wireline Products, and Executive Director, Head of

Corporate Strategy. Prior to Telstra, Mr. Bray was a Partner with McKinsey & Company in Europe. His background also includes investment banking, where he served as a Managing Director and Head of Telecommunications Equity Research with JP Morgan and Dresdner Kleinwort Wasserstein. Past board memberships include Opera Australia, Spark New Zealand, Foxtel, and CSL (Hong Kong). He served as Chairman of the Australian Mobile Telecommunications Association (AMTA) and on the strategy committee of the GSMA.

3.7.3. Core Expertise, Skills, and Educational Qualifications: His core areas of expertise include financial management and strategy, telecommunications industry dynamics, technology application in business, media sector trends, M&A, capital expenditure management, operational effectiveness improvement, equity research, and data analytics. Mr. Bray holds a Bachelor of Science with Honours (BSci (Hons)) and a Master of Business Administration (MBA) from the University of Melbourne.

3.7.4. Committee Memberships and Responsibilities: At Woolworths, Mr. Bray serves as Chair of the Audit & Finance Committee. He is also a Non-executive Director of Spark New Zealand Limited.

3.7.5. Inferred Preferences and Public Stance: His career implies a strong focus on financial discipline, strategic growth initiatives, and shareholder value creation. During his time as Telstra CFO, he articulated an emphasis on customer advocacy and maintaining excellence in core products and services while investing for future growth. He has spoken about the benefits of democratising data within organisations (with appropriate governance and controls) to improve decision-making.

3.7.6. Likely Key Areas of Focus and Influence within Woolworths Board Meetings: As Chair of the Audit & Finance Committee, Mr. Bray's primary influence is in financial oversight, audit integrity, and financial strategy. His tenure as Telstra CFO during significant industry disruption (NBN rollout, mobile competition) equips him to guide Woolworths' financial strategy through its own technology-driven transformation. His career spanning McKinsey, investment banking, and senior corporate roles provides a holistic view — from strategy formulation through market valuation to operational execution. He will play a key role in scrutinising technology and digital investments for financial viability and strategic alignment. He is well-positioned to engage with Jon Alferness on the financial implications of technology strategy, ensuring rigorous ROI discipline is applied to digital transformation initiatives.

3.8. Ken Meyer

3.8.1. Official Role and Tenure at Woolworths Group: Ken Meyer is a Non-Executive Director of Woolworths Group, appointed on 1 October 2025. He is a US resident and stood for election at the 2025 AGM.

3.8.2. Comprehensive Professional Background and Experience: Mr. Meyer brings extensive food retail experience to the Board, having spent 24 years at Whole Foods Market — a US-based grocery chain known for its high-quality fresh food, in-store experience, and customer service. He began his natural foods career in labour scheduling and logistics at Fresh Fields, which was acquired by Whole Foods Market in 1996. Over the following two decades, he ascended through progressively senior leadership roles, including Regional President of the South region, Regional Vice-President of the Southwest region, Store Team Leader of the Georgetown store, and eventually to Executive Vice President of Operations for North America and the United Kingdom. In 2012, he was promoted to EVP of Operations, joining the executive leadership team reporting directly to co-founders John Mackey and Walter Robb. In this role, he oversaw day-to-day operations, development, design, and innovation of both new and existing stores, the global culinary and hospitality team, the global supply chain and retail operations support team, and acquisitions of numerous manufacturing and retail food companies. He played a key role in the growth of Whole Foods to more than 500 stores across the US and UK, and its eventual sale to Amazon in 2017. He continued in his role until 2019 and was inducted into the Whole Foods Market Hall of Fame in 2020.

Post-Whole Foods, Mr. Meyer founded One Handshake Partners, a holding company and advisory platform

focused on discovering, nurturing, and investing in next-generation entrepreneurs and emerging food brands.

3.8.3. Core Expertise, Skills, and Educational Qualifications: His core expertise encompasses food retail operations at scale, fresh food innovation and meal solutions, store design and development, retail supply chain and logistics, in-store customer experience, grocery retail operations, perishables management, emerging food brands and innovation pipeline, food and beverage private equity, and purpose-driven business leadership. Mr. Meyer holds a Bachelor of Science in Food Systems Economics and Management.

3.8.4. Committee Memberships and Responsibilities: At Woolworths, Mr. Meyer's committee assignments are to be confirmed. Given his expertise, he is likely to be aligned with committees focused on operations, sustainability, or customer experience. He was a member of the Board of Directors of Whole Kids Foundation and Whole Planet Foundation during his time at Whole Foods.

3.8.5. Other Current and Past Directorships and Key Affiliations: Mr. Meyer currently serves as an Executive Partner at Shore Capital, a Chicago-based private equity firm focused on investments in the food and beverage sector (approximately \$13 billion in assets under management; Food & Beverage Fund III closed at over \$450 million in 2025). He is also a Founding Partner and Investment Committee Member at Midnight Ventures Partners, an early-stage fund focused on emerging food and consumer brands, and an Operating Partner at STORY3 Capital, an alternative investment manager focused on the consumer value chain.

3.8.6. Inferred Preferences and Public Stance: Mr. Meyer is deeply grounded in the operational realities of food retail, having risen through the ranks from labour scheduling to the executive leadership team over 24 years. His career at Whole Foods — a company built on fresh food excellence, supplier partnerships, and purpose-driven business — suggests a strong advocacy for quality-led differentiation over price-led competition. He values supplier partnerships and relationship-based approaches to building brands and categories. His involvement with Whole Kids Foundation and Whole Planet Foundation reflects a commitment to purpose-driven business and conscious capitalism. His current private equity roles indicate ongoing engagement with the food and beverage ecosystem and a focus on innovation, scalability, and emerging consumer trends.

3.8.7. Likely Key Areas of Focus and Influence within Woolworths Board Meetings: Mr. Meyer's appointment directly addresses the Board's need for deep operational food retail expertise, particularly in fresh food — an area former CEO Brad Banducci identified as a top strategic priority ("Reinventing Fresh End-to-End"). His experience at Whole Foods, where fresh food excellence was the core competitive moat, means he will be a forceful voice on fresh food strategy, meal solutions innovation ("EAT/HEAT/COOK"), own-brand development in fresh categories, and end-to-end fresh supply chain optimisation. His experience of the Amazon acquisition provides firsthand insight into how Amazon approaches grocery retail — directly relevant given Amazon's growing presence in Australia.

His current private equity roles at Shore Capital and Midnight Ventures keep him actively engaged in the food and beverage ecosystem, giving him visibility into emerging brands, innovation trends, and the financial dynamics of food businesses at various scales. He will challenge proposals that focus disproportionately on support office optimisation or packaged goods at the expense of fresh food transformation. He is likely to advocate for quality-led differentiation and partnership-based supplier relationships over purely transactional approaches.

As Woolworths Group Chair Scott Perkins noted at his appointment, Ken's experience "aligns with our focus on retail excellence and fresh food." He is a natural collaborator with Kathee Tesija on retail operations and supply chain discussions, bringing complementary fresh food and premium grocery expertise to Tesija's mass-market merchandising and supply chain background. He may need time to build familiarity with Australian regulatory, industrial relations, and competitive dynamics, but his operational depth and

international perspective make him a significant addition to the Board.

3.9. Jon Alferness

3.9.1. Official Role and Tenure at Woolworths Group: Jon Alferness is a Non-Executive Director of Woolworths Group, appointed on 1 March 2026. He is a US resident and will stand for election at the 2026 Annual General Meeting.

3.9.2. Comprehensive Professional Background and Experience: Mr. Alferness is a highly experienced technology and product leader with more than 20 years' experience in Silicon Valley and the global retail sector, including recent focus on the food and grocery sector. His career has been defined by senior executive roles delivering digital transformation and innovation at Walmart, Google, Lyft, Pinterest, and Varo Bank.

Most recently, Mr. Alferness served as Executive Vice President and Chief Product Officer for Walmart US (2022–2024), a role encompassing eCommerce, Financial Services, Health & Wellness, Merchant Tools, and Last Mile Delivery. He led the digital and physical customer experience and team member tools, overseeing the integration of advanced digital capabilities — including generative AI — into daily operations at the world's largest retailer. He was instrumental in uniting these disciplines to enhance customer experience and operational efficiency. His departure from Walmart in late 2024 followed an organisational restructure.

Prior to Walmart, Mr. Alferness was the Chief Product Officer and Executive Vice President of Technology at Varo Bank (2021–2022), where he led engineering, product, design, and science, advancing the company's inclusive banking mission. He was previously Vice President of Rideshare at Lyft (2020–2021), leading engineering, product, and revenue for the core ridesharing business — providing experience in logistics, marketplace dynamics, and gig economy operations. He held a senior role at Pinterest as President and SVP of Ads and Commerce (2017–2018), leading the company's revenue operation after the departure of its president, gaining experience in advertising technology, consumer engagement platforms, and e-commerce discovery. Before that, he spent 13 years at Google (2004–2017) as Vice President of Product Management, leading teams for shopping, travel, mobile ads, and search ads. During this tenure, he built deep expertise in search optimisation, advertising technology, e-commerce product development, and mobile commerce at massive scale.

Mr. Alferness lives in the San Francisco Bay Area and is a board member of ExtraFood.org, a food rescue organisation, reflecting his commitment to food-related social causes.

3.9.3. Core Expertise, Skills, and Educational Qualifications: His core expertise encompasses technology and product leadership at scale, digital transformation in retail (particularly grocery), e-commerce platform development, generative AI application in retail, search and advertising technology, last-mile delivery, customer and associate experience design, mobile product strategy, marketplace systems, fintech, data science, and cross-functional team leadership. Mr. Alferness holds a Bachelor of Science in Computer Science from Cornell University and pursued graduate studies in Computer Science at Caltech.

3.9.4. Committee Memberships and Responsibilities: At Woolworths, Mr. Alferness's committee assignments are to be confirmed as the newest director. Given his expertise, he is likely to be aligned with committees focused on technology strategy, digital transformation, and potentially risk (technology and cyber). He is also an Independent Director at Gores Technology Partners II, Inc. (a technology-focused SPAC).

3.9.5. Other Current and Past Directorships and Key Affiliations: Mr. Alferness currently serves as an Independent Director of Gores Technology Partners II, Inc. and as a board member of ExtraFood.org. He

has been affiliated with Columbia Business School's Executives in Residence programme.

3.9.6. Inferred Preferences and Public Stance: Mr. Alferness's career and public statements reveal a consistent philosophy of "people led, tech enabled" — valuing the human element alongside technology deployment. At Walmart, he emphasised that the company's culture puts customers and associates first, with technology as an enabler rather than an end in itself. He advocates for truth-telling, empowering teams, and assuming positive intent as core leadership principles. He is willing to take calculated risks with new technologies, as demonstrated by his pioneering of GenAI initiatives at Walmart. He believes in empowering front-line associates with technology tools, describing AI as a "superpower" for associates. He brings a Silicon Valley product management discipline — rapid experimentation, data-driven iteration, and measurable outcomes — combined with an appreciation for the operational complexity of physical retail. His commitment to ExtraFood.org and his interest in food-related social causes suggest alignment with Woolworths' purpose-driven values.

3.9.7. Likely Key Areas of Focus and Influence within Woolworths Board Meetings: Mr. Alferness's appointment signals the Board's intensifying focus on technology as a core competitive differentiator in retail. His experience as CPO at Walmart US — the world's largest retailer and a direct strategic comparator for Woolworths — provides exceptionally relevant insights into how technology can transform both customer experience and operational efficiency at massive scale. He has led the practical deployment of generative AI in retail operations, making him a critical voice as Woolworths develops its own AI strategy.

His 13 years at Google provide deep expertise in search, advertising technology, and e-commerce product development directly relevant to WooliesX and Woolworths' digital platforms. His experience at Lyft (logistics and marketplace dynamics) and Varo Bank (fintech and financial inclusion) add additional dimensions relevant to Woolworths' last-mile delivery challenges and potential financial services ambitions.

Mr. Alferness replaces Tracey Fellows' technology and digital expertise on the Board but brings a more retail-specific and operationally grounded perspective. Where Fellows brought digital media and real estate platform experience (News Corp, REA Group, Microsoft), Alferness brings direct food and grocery retail technology leadership from the world's largest retailer. He will be a natural collaborator with CEO Amanda Bardwell on digital strategy, while providing independent challenge on technology investment priorities, platform architecture decisions, and the pace of AI adoption. Warwick Bray, as Audit & Finance Chair, will be a key counterpart in ensuring financial rigour is applied to the technology initiatives Alferness champions.

His emphasis on integrating digital and physical channels — rather than treating them as separate businesses — is particularly relevant as Woolworths navigates the challenge of optimising its store network with 25%+ e-commerce mix while avoiding operating deleverage on in-store shopping. His experience building supplier platform tools at Walmart (Supplier One) may also inform Woolworths' approach to supplier engagement and technology-enabled supply chain management.

As the newest Board member, Mr. Alferness will need time to understand Australian market dynamics, regulatory environment, and Woolworths' specific operational context. However, his combination of Silicon Valley product discipline and direct retail operational experience — rare in the Australian board landscape — makes him a distinctive and strategically valuable addition.

4. Synthesised Board Analysis: Collective Strengths and Strategic Alignment

4.1. Dominant Expertise and Experience Clusters on the Board

The Woolworths Group Board exhibits several dominant clusters of expertise, reflecting a deliberate

composition designed to address the multifaceted challenges and opportunities in the contemporary retail sector:

Retail Operations, Merchandising & Fresh Food: This foundational area is strongly represented by Amanda Bardwell, with her extensive operational and marketing background within Woolworths; Kathee Tesija, whose career culminated as Chief Merchandising and Supply Chain Officer at Target Corporation; and now Ken Meyer, whose 24 years at Whole Foods Market provide deep expertise specifically in fresh food operations, store development, and perishables supply chain. The addition of Meyer materially strengthens the Board's operational food retail capability, particularly in fresh food — an area previously identified as a strategic gap.

Digital, E-commerce, Technology & AI: A very significant and strategically vital cluster includes Amanda Bardwell, the architect of WooliesX's success; Jennifer Carr-Smith, with her CEO experience at Peapod and leadership in other e-commerce ventures; Jon Alferness, with his CPO experience at Walmart US, 13 years at Google, and direct experience deploying generative AI in retail; and Warwick Bray, whose experience at Telstra involved significant technology and product leadership alongside his financial roles. The replacement of Tracey Fellows with Jon Alferness upgrades this cluster with more retail-specific and operationally grounded technology expertise, including direct grocery AI and last-mile delivery experience.

Finance, Strategy & Corporate Governance: Robust oversight is provided by Scott Perkins, with his M&A and corporate finance background; Maxine Brenner, with her investment banking, legal, and extensive board experience; Philip Chronican, current NAB Chair and former NAB CEO and Westpac CFO; and Warwick Bray, former Telstra CFO and McKinsey partner. This group ensures strong financial discipline and strategic direction.

Sustainability & ESG: Following Holly Kramer's departure as Chair of the Sustainability Committee, this area is represented by Kathee Tesija (committee member), Jennifer Carr-Smith (committee member, with directorships in innovative food companies), Scott Perkins (chairing Origin Energy during its energy transition), Maxine Brenner (chairing Telstra's Risk and Sustainability Committee), Philip Chronican (strong interest in climate impact), and Ken Meyer (purpose-driven food retail background, Whole Planet Foundation). The Board retains breadth of sustainability interest but has lost Kramer's dedicated ESG governance leadership — a gap that needs to be addressed through new Sustainability Committee Chair appointment.

4.2. Alignment of Board Capabilities with Woolworths' Strategic Imperatives

The collective capabilities of the Board appear well-aligned with Woolworths Group's key strategic imperatives:

Digital Transformation, AI & E-commerce Growth: The Board is exceptionally well-equipped to guide and scrutinise this critical area, with the deep expertise of Bardwell, Carr-Smith, Alferness, and Bray directly aligning with Woolworths' stated focus on digital capabilities. The addition of Alferness — with direct experience deploying GenAI at Walmart and building integrated digital-physical retail experiences — represents a significant upgrade in the Board's ability to provide both strategic guidance and informed challenge on technology investments. This concentration of expertise suggests an offensive strategy designed to achieve technology leadership in retail, rather than merely reacting to market shifts.

Fresh Food Excellence & Retail Operations: The addition of Ken Meyer addresses what was previously a gap in the Board's operational food retail depth, particularly in fresh food. With Bardwell providing internal operational knowledge, Tesija providing US mass-market merchandising and supply chain expertise, and now Meyer providing deep fresh food, store operations, and perishables supply chain experience, the Board has significantly strengthened its capability to oversee Woolworths' "Reinventing Fresh" agenda and

compete effectively in its core business.

Customer Trust & Brand Reputation: Several directors, including Scott Perkins, Amanda Bardwell, Maxine Brenner, and Philip Chronican, have direct experience in customer-facing leadership roles or have navigated significant reputational challenges. This collective experience is crucial given the ongoing scrutiny faced by major retailers regarding pricing, competition, and social responsibility.

Sustainability: The strong interest of Perkins, Brenner, Carr-Smith, Chronican, Tesija, and Meyer in sustainability matters maintains breadth. However, the Board needs to address the leadership gap created by Holly Kramer's departure as Sustainability Committee Chair.

Navigating a Competitive & Challenging Retail Environment: The combined experience in retail leadership (Bardwell, Tesija, Meyer), technology (Alferness, Carr-Smith, Bray), finance (Perkins, Chronican, Bray, Brenner), and strategy (Perkins, Bray, Brenner) provides a robust foundation for guiding Woolworths through economic headwinds, intense competition, and complex supply chain dynamics. The addition of two US-based directors with direct experience of Amazon's (Meyer) and Walmart's (Alferness) retail strategies is particularly relevant given these companies' growing influence in the Australian market.

4.3. Potential Dynamics and Areas of Collective Board Focus

Based on the renewed board composition and the current operating environment, several key areas of collective focus and dynamics can be anticipated:

An aggressive push on technology and AI utilisation is expected, with significant board support for — and rigorous scrutiny of — digital initiatives, now informed by direct Walmart, Google, and Peapod experience alongside Amanda Bardwell's internal digital leadership.

A reinvigorated focus on fresh food strategy and retail operational excellence, driven by Ken Meyer's appointment and aligned with the CEO's strategic priorities and Brad Banducci's departing counsel on "Reinventing Fresh."

Heightened focus on risk management, particularly in areas such as cybersecurity (increasing digital reliance), supply chain resilience, regulatory compliance (ongoing grocery sector inquiries), and AI governance (as deployment accelerates). The expertise of Brenner, Chronican, Bray, and Alferness will be central.

A critical dynamic will be balancing ambitious digital and fresh food growth objectives with profitability imperatives, especially within e-commerce where margins remain a concern. The Board's financial expertise (Perkins, Chronican, Bray, Brenner) will drive this discipline.

Ongoing refinement of the customer value proposition, navigating inflation, cost-of-living pressures, and competition while rebuilding trust.

A potential dynamic to watch is the integration of two new US-based directors (Meyer and Alferness) into a Board that operates within Australian corporate governance, regulatory, and cultural norms. Their international perspectives are a significant asset, but effective integration will require the Chair's facilitation and the new directors' willingness to engage deeply with the Australian context.

The Board possesses a potent combination of deep internal knowledge (CEO Bardwell), extensive external multi-sector experience (Perkins, Brenner, Chronican, Bray), and now significantly strengthened international retail-specific expertise (Meyer, Alferness, Tesija, Carr-Smith). This blend is conducive to fostering robust strategic discussions, balancing operational realities with broader market trends, emerging technologies,

and international best practices.

5. Concluding Observations

The Woolworths Group Board of Directors, as constituted in March 2026, represents a well-constructed and strategically aligned governing body with the collective expertise to guide the company through a dynamic and challenging retail environment. The recent renewal — adding Ken Meyer and Jon Alferness while farewelling Holly Kramer and Tracey Fellows — reflects a deliberate strategic sharpening of the Board's capabilities.

The Board's most striking feature remains its significant commitment to digital and data-driven strategies, now reinforced by the addition of Jon Alferness, who brings direct retail-specific technology leadership including generative AI deployment experience from the world's largest retailer. Combined with CEO Bardwell's digital transformation track record, Jennifer Carr-Smith's online grocery expertise, and Warwick Bray's technology-finance perspective, the Board has one of the most digitally capable governance structures in Australian retail.

The addition of Ken Meyer provides the Board with deep operational food retail expertise — particularly in fresh food, an area critical to Woolworths' competitive positioning and identified by former CEO Brad Banducci as a top strategic priority. His experience complements Kathee Tesija's mass-market merchandising and supply chain expertise, creating a stronger collective capability in the Board's core retail domain.

The Board maintains strong commitment to financial rigour, corporate governance, ethical conduct, and stakeholder management through the experienced contributions of Scott Perkins, Maxine Brenner, Philip Chronican, and Warwick Bray. The collective experience of several directors in navigating intense public and regulatory scrutiny and driving cultural change remains a significant asset as Woolworths manages its own reputational challenges.

The primary gap to address following the Board renewal is the Sustainability Committee Chair role vacated by Holly Kramer. While sustainability expertise and interest is broadly distributed across the Board, dedicated governance leadership in this area is important given growing stakeholder expectations and Woolworths' public commitments.

The blend of long-serving directors with deep institutional knowledge, experienced Australian corporate leaders, and now two US-based directors with cutting-edge international retail and technology experience, should foster a dynamic and challenging environment for strategic decision-making. This diversity of thought, experience, and geographic perspective is crucial for navigating the complexities facing Woolworths Group and avoiding insularity — particularly as the competitive landscape is increasingly shaped by global players like Amazon and digitally-native retail models.

Overall, the Woolworths Group Board appears well-equipped to support the executive team in pursuing growth, managing risks, and enhancing the Group's reputation and performance, with a clear strategic emphasis on fresh food excellence, technology-led retail transformation, customer-centricity, and sustainable practices.